



When to use which tool

Hello, there. In these videos, you've been introduced to spreadsheets, SQL, and so many other tools. We've also talked about choosing the right tool before you start a project, but sometimes, you find yourself stuck on a problem during your data analysis. That might mean it's time to reconsider which tool you're using for the job. For example, if you're working with a simple spreadsheet, maybe 5 to 10 rows and a few columns, then pivot tables are a great way to visualize that data. But if that spreadsheet is more than a million rows, it'll start to crash, making a pivot table hard to complete. When you find yourself working with a huge spreadsheet that keeps crashing, you might switch the SQL to pull the data you need from different locations in a database, instead of from a single spreadsheet.

You might remember that SQL can handle trillions of rows of data, and is now a standard language for working with database programs. SQL is great for querying, updating, and optimizing data. Having a variety of tools in your toolkit is important as a data analyst, but just as important as knowing when to use them. If you find yourself stuck on a problem, it can be a good idea to take a step back and reconsider how you're approaching a task. Do you have too much data for a single spreadsheet? Switch to SQL. You also know how to find answers online now, so if you ever run into a problem and need to try a different tool, a quick search can be really helpful.

There might be resources online or someone else may have had the same problem and posted about it. This is great if you start feeling stuck on a problem, and you might even find a new way to use a tool you're already familiar with. And that brings us to the end of this module, great job! We've covered a lot of information, we learned about converting and formatting data, how to combine multiple pieces of data, and how to search for help when you need support during your analysis. Coming up next, you'll take on the Weekly Challenge. As always, feel free to go back over anything we've learned from these past videos, then I'll see you for the next video, good luck!